

# Hospice Eligibility Quick Reference

Clinical Criteria by Diagnosis

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## GENERAL ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

- Terminal prognosis of 6 months or less if disease runs its normal course
- Patient elects comfort focused care over curative treatment
- Certification by attending physician and hospice medical director

## CANCER

- Metastatic or locally advanced disease
- Disease progression despite treatment or patient declines further treatment
- Declining functional status (KPS 50 or below)

## HEART DISEASE

- NYHA Class IV symptoms despite optimal treatment
- Ejection fraction 20% or less
- Refractory angina or recurrent hospitalizations
- History of cardiac arrest or syncope

## COPD AND PULMONARY DISEASE

- Disabling dyspnea at rest
- FEV1 below 30% predicted
- Progressive disease with increasing ER visits or hospitalizations
- Cor pulmonale or right heart failure

## DEMENTIA AND ALZHEIMER'S

- FAST Scale Stage 7 or beyond
- Inability to ambulate, dress, or bathe without assistance

- Urinary and fecal incontinence
- Limited meaningful speech (fewer than 6 intelligible words per day)
- Plus a comorbid condition within the past 12 months

## RENAL DISEASE

- Patient not seeking or discontinuing dialysis
- Creatinine clearance below 10 ml/min
- Serum creatinine above 8.0 mg/dl with comorbid conditions

## LIVER DISEASE

- Prothrombin time more than 5 seconds over control
- Serum albumin less than 2.5 g/dl
- Refractory ascites or hepatic encephalopathy

## STROKE AND CVA

- Coma or persistent vegetative state beyond 3 days
- Dysphagia preventing adequate food and fluid intake
- Post stroke dementia with FAST Stage 7 or beyond

## ADULT FAILURE TO THRIVE

- BMI under 22
- Unintentional weight loss exceeding 10% in 6 months
- Declining functional status and serum albumin under 2.5

### FIELD NOTE

You do not need to memorize every criterion. Know the most common diagnoses in your territory and keep this card accessible. When in doubt, ask your clinical team for a consultation.